



MYUNG J. CHUN Los Angeles Times

A HOLIDAY CELEBRATION

Sisters Ailani Loving, 9, left, and Jaylin King, 21, pose at L.A.'s Leimert Park, among the many June-tenth events held nationwide Friday. In Chicago, the Obama center opened to the public. **NATION, A8**

Future of storied B-52 up in the air

This week's deadly crash focuses new scrutiny on the aging military warhorse.

By Salvador Hernandez

The B-52 bomber is considered a marvel not only of the U.S. military but of all aviation history.

The massive plane remains a workhorse for the Air Force seven decades after it debuted in the 1950s, and military officials believe the fleet can continue through the century mark with regular modifications and modernization.

Prized for their payloads, long ranges and ability to fly at high altitudes, B-52s have played a role in many U.S. conflicts, including the war with Iran.

Now, an inquiry into why a B-52 Stratofortress crashed Monday shortly after takeoff at Edwards Air Force Base, killing eight, is renewing questions about the 70-year-old planes, their purpose in the rapidly modernizing military landscape and their future.

Experts say the probe will likely include a review of the entire aging heavy bomber fleet, including past and upcoming upgrades to the plane that the Air Force has called the "backbone" of its manned bomber force.

"The problem is that you do the math, and equipment that was bought in the Cold War is getting pretty old, and there comes a point where these front-line aircraft, [See B-52s, A8]

He never got a chance to pick up his diploma

Just one day after walking the stage, a South L.A. grad was taken away at a routine ICE check-in

By Itzel Luna

Wilber Urbina Garcia had an ambitious list of errands to run the day after his high school graduation, before his summer really began.

The shy boy was the first in his family to walk the graduation stage, and he was determined to get a head start on his future. He had a diploma to pick up, a high school textbook to return and fall classes to register for at El Camino College.

Those plans had to wait until the family completed a check-in with Immigration and Customs Enforcement that morning. The appointments had become second nature since they entered the country from Nicaragua seeking asylum in late 2022.

The family of five left their South Los Angeles home before sunrise and arrived at the federal courthouse ahead of their 8 a.m. appointment.

That evening, they came home without Wilber. He had been taken into custody by immigration agents.

"All he wanted was to learn, but all of

his dreams just came crashing down," said Winston Garcia, one of Wilber's older brothers. "We don't know what's going to happen to him. We don't know if he'll get out, or when."

Even the scorching sun wasn't enough to wipe the smiles off the Garcia family's faces as they watched Wilber cross the stage at Jordan High School on June 9, graduating with high honors.

The family posed next to Wilber, who had long struggled to speak up but had flourished in the last four years. Winston's phone filled up with photos of Wilber with friends, teachers and counselors.

Those same teachers rushed to write character references when they found out that Wilber had been detained by ICE.

They describe a shy but headstrong kid, who was extremely disciplined and dedicated to his studies. By his senior year, Wilber could present projects in English and held leadership roles at the school.

[See Graduate, A6]

Screenwriting, with an AI assist

When Brian Grazer has an idea for a movie, he now starts with a chatbot. The co-founder of Imagine Entertainment — the company behind "A Beautiful Mind," "Apollo 13" and "Liar Liar" — said he sits down with Anthropic's AI assistant, Claude, to rough out a story before handing it to a writer.

"You can build the whole thing into an outline. You still need a screenwriter. I always believe you need a screenwriter," Grazer said during a keynote at UCLA's Entertainment Symposium on Thursday. What once could have taken up to a

As Hollywood debates money and control, some use new tech to augment traditional methods

By Cerys Davies

year, he said, now takes him about a week — but the human writer stays.

That balance — AI as an accelerator rather than a replacement — captures where much of Hollywood has landed in practice. Amazon MGM, Lionsgate, Netflix and Disney have all made major investments in the technology. The sharper question at the symposium, which drew many of the industry's top lawyers and dealmakers to the Westwood campus, was not whether to use AI but how: who authorizes it, how far it [See AI, A12]

Hezbollah and Israel agree to a fragile truce

Fighting in Lebanon derails planned U.S.-Iran talks and threatens new pact.

By Erin Cunningham, Jon Gambrell and Aamer Madhani

JERUSALEM — Israel and the Iranian-backed Hezbollah militant group agreed Friday to halt the heavy fighting in southern Lebanon that derailed peace talks planned between the U.S. and Iran and threatened to unravel their interim agreement to end their war, officials said.

Neither Israel nor Hezbollah immediately confirmed the truce.

It came after a heavy exchange of fire killed 47 people in Lebanon and four Israeli soldiers.

Hezbollah and Israel went to war shortly after the outbreak of the wider conflict, with Hezbollah firing rockets and drones at civilian communities in northern Israel and Israel seizing large swaths of southern Lebanon. Iranian officials did not

travel as planned to Switzerland, where a ceremonial resigning of the deal between the U.S. and Iran had been planned Friday to kick off negotiations on Tehran's nuclear program and other details over the next 60 days. The Iranians insisted that the fighting in Lebanon must stop before the talks can take place, according to three regional officials and a fourth person familiar with the matter who spoke on condition of anonymity to discuss sensitive conversations behind the scenes. U.S. Vice President JD Vance also postponed his trip.

The future talks are supposed to bring about a permanent end to the conflict.

On Friday, Iranian Foreign Ministry spokesperson Esmail Baghaei said consultations through mediators were ongoing regarding the next phase of negotiations to draft a final agreement.

Because the initial deal was signed digitally earlier this week, the talks in Switzerland were not urgent, and plans were underway to hold a meeting in the coming days, he said.

The interim agreement [See Iran, A3]

Measles is again detected at LAX

Health officials urge caution amid World Cup crowds in L.A. and the Bay Area.

By Rong-Gong Lin II

A person infected with measles flew on a trans-Pacific flight and passed through Los Angeles International Airport last week, potentially exposing other passengers to the highly contagious disease.

This latest case comes as travelers surge into Los Angeles and the San Francisco Bay Area for the FIFA World Cup, and as measles is on the upswing — posing a particular risk to the unvaccinated, including infants who are too young to be inoculated and for whom the disease can be especially dangerous.

"I think they seem to be popping up more and more often," said Dr. Peter

Chin-Hong, a UC San Francisco infectious diseases expert, "and that's because it really reflects how much measles there is — not just in the U.S. or even Mexico and Canada, but around the world."

This is the fourth measles case confirmed in a passenger passing through LAX while possibly contagious this year, and the sixth case overall reported by L.A. County health officials. Just a few days earlier, health officials in the Bay Area warned that a measles-infected passenger had also traveled through San Francisco International Airport and potentially exposed others to the disease while visiting stores in San José.

"With summer travel underway and Los Angeles County welcoming large gatherings and international visitors during World Cup events, the risk of exposure to infectious diseases [See Measles, A7]

LAPD killing of family dog sparks outrage

The fatal shooting occurred amid a Knicks championship celebration

By Ruben Vives, Richard Winton and Summer Lin

The New York Knicks had just won the NBA championship Saturday night when Los Angeles police were called to an apartment complex in Canoga Park amid reports of a person screaming.

Minutes later, an officer opened fire on a pet Saint Bernard doodle that was wearing a Knicks shirt.

The death of Jameson has sparked outrage and questions across the city, prompting Los Angeles Police Chief Jim McDonnell to promise a full investigation and Mayor Karen Bass to offer a public tribute to the dog.

"Every life lost to violence is a tragedy, and we know that the devastating loss of Jameson will be felt by his family forever," Bass said in a statement amid mounting outcry.

A video widely shared on social media shows the dog's owner sobbing in



VANESSA MARSEILLE

JAMESON, a 2-year-old Saint Bernard doodle, was fatally shot by Los Angeles police officers.

the hallway of the apartment complex, hugging Jameson as six L.A. police officers stand nearby.

"The Knicks just won a championship, we were so happy," she yells out.

Neighbors can be heard angrily admonishing officers for killing the dog.

The incident has raised new questions about use-of-force protocols when it comes to dogs and whether reforms are needed.

Police have offered only a limited narrative of what happened.

Officers arrived and spoke with the resident who had been reportedly screaming.

LAPD officers said they got to the woman's apartment and asked her to secure her dog. She closed the door and opened it again, which is when Jameson went outside.

Police say Jameson then "charged" an officer, who fatally shot the 2-year-old pup.

[See Dog, A7]



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U.S. BEATS AUSTRALIA

Chris Richards and Alex Zendejas celebrate the Americans' 2-0 victory, which clinches a spot in the World Cup's knockout round. **SPORTS, B12**

Trump shows off Air Force One

The new aircraft, a controversial gift from Qatar, is white on top half with a navy blue underbelly. **NATION, A6**

Weather Clearing, L.A. Basin: 75/60. **B8**

Obituaries **B5**
Opinion Voices **A13**

Revered sitcom director dies

James Burrows, 85, turned "Taxi," "Cheers" and "Friends" into fan faves. **CALIFORNIA, B5**

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